

Stefan Nielsen

Research Experience

Sakana AI

Research Scientist

Tokyo, Japan

6/25 - present

- [Fugu Team](#), responsible for training and evaluating Fugu-Ultra v1-2 and Fugu-Cyber
- Research in multi-agent orchestration and reinforcement learning

National University of Singapore, Department of Mathematics

FPT Software, AI Center

Research Resident

Singapore

Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam

3/23 - 3/25

- Research in Professor [Tan Minh Nguyen](#)'s Mathematical AI lab in statistical foundations of deep learning

Columbia University, Data Science Institute

Research Scholar

New York City, USA

6/22 - 3/23

- Research in Professor [Talia Gillis](#)'s lab in machine bias and algorithmic fairness.

Columbia University, Zuckerman Institute

Research Assistant

New York City, USA

9/22 - 12/22

- Research in Professor [Liam Paninski](#)'s lab in contrastive learning for spike sorting in computational neuroscience

Selected Publications

Learning to Orchestrate Agents in Natural Language with the Conductor

Stefan Nielsen, Edoardo Cetin, Peter Schwendeman, Qi Sun, Jinglue Xu, Yujin Tang

International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2026

Trinity: An Evolved LLM Coordinator

Jinglue Xu, Qi Sun, Peter Schwedndeman, Stefan Nielsen, Edoardo Cetin, Yujin Tang

International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2026

Evolutionary Context Search for Automated Skill Acquisition

Qi Sun, Stefan Nielsen, Rio Yokota, Yujin Tang

Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR) 2026

Tight Clusters Make Specialized Experts

Stefan Nielsen, Rachel S.Y Teo, Laziz Abdullaev, Tan M. Nguyen

International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2025

Elliptical Attention

Stefan Nielsen, Laziz Abdullaev, Rachel S.Y. Teo, Tan M. Nguyen

Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2024

Education

Columbia University

MA in Statistics (Cumulative GPA: 4.00/4.00)

New York City, USA

University of Cambridge

MPhil in Economics

Cambridge, UK

Thesis: Failed Coalition Formation under the Nash Bargaining Solution: Using Threat Stochasticity to Explain Non-participation

London School of Economics

BSc in Economics, Politics, Philosophy (First; graduated top 5 in class)

London, UK

Awards / Honors

Poster Presenter, International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) Main Conference	2025, 2026
Huayu Enrichment Scholarship, Government of Taiwan Fully funded scholarship to live in Taiwan and take intensive mandarin classes	2024
Poster Presenter, Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) Main Conference	2024
Oral Presenter, FPT Software AI Research Symposium	2024
Funded Research Scholar, Columbia University, Data Science Institute	2022-2023

Service / Other

Reviewer	
- Main conference, International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)	2025, 2026
- Main conference, International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)	2026
- Main conference, Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)	2025, 2026
- Workshop on Modularity for Collaborative, Decentralized, and Continual Deep Learning, ICLR	2025
Producer and Artist, An Việt Archives, Hackney, London	2024
- Produced <i>Well Settled</i> , a commissioned art piece by Hackney arts council drawing on the An Việt archives to explore the role of sound and its contribution to Vietnamese shared heritage in transnational contexts	
- Produced <i>‘Our Tones, Our Wrists, Our Home’</i> with Nic Anette Miller, archiving forms of Vietnamese sign language and its role in sharing the heritage of the deaf refugee community	
Languages: English (native), Vietnamese (advanced), German (intermediate)	